TGPSC GROUP 1 MAINS

Paper II · Unit I · Topic 4

Anti-British Uprisings, Nationalism and Social Reform

Expanded teaching draft — not yet verified or approved

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Syllabus and Index

Anti – British uprisings: Tribal and Peasant revolts in the Nineteenth Century-Causes and Consequences of 1857 revolt. Factors responsible for the rise of Indian Nationalism; Rise and Growth of Socio- Religious and Anti-Caste Movements: Brahma Samaj, Arya Samaj, Aligarh Movement, Satya Shodak Samaj, Jotiba and Savithribhai Phule, Pandita Ramabai, Narayana Guru, Ayyankali, Annie Beasant; Non- Brahmin, Justice and Self-Respect Movements: Periyar, Mahatma Gandhi, Ambedkar and others.

Coverage

Tribal and peasant uprisings: detailed notes section 2; 1857: section 3; rise of nationalism: section 4; Brahmo, Arya, Aligarh, Phules, Ramabai, Narayana Guru, Ayyankali and Besant: section 5; Justice, Self-Respect, Periyar, Gandhi and Ambedkar: section 6.

Transcription inherited from project; amendment check pending.

Quick Revision

- 1831–32: Kol uprising in Chotanagpur; disputes over land, authority and outsiders.

- 1855–56: Santhal Hul; Sidhu and Kanhu; resistance to exploitation and colonial institutions.

- 1857: Meerut uprising on 10 May; Delhi became symbolic center; diverse regional leadership.

- 1858: Company rule ended; authority transferred to Crown; Queen’s Proclamation.

- 1859–60: Indigo revolt in Bengal; coercive contracts and peasant collective action.

- 1873: Satyashodhak Samaj founded by Jyotirao Phule.

- 1875: Arya Samaj founded; Deccan disturbances; MAO College founded at Aligarh.

- 1885: Indian National Congress founded.

- 1899–1900: Birsa Munda’s Ulgulan.

- 1908: Chotanagpur Tenancy Act; part of longer tenure-rights history.

- 1916: Justice Party political organization established; Annie Besant’s Home Rule activity.

- 1925: Self-Respect Movement associated with Periyar.

- 1932: Poona Pact: reserved seats within joint electorates.

Distinguish in answers

Trigger vs structural cause: Enfield cartridge controversy vs annexation, military grievances and revenue politics in 1857.

Peasant vs tribal movements: Overlap in economic grievances; different claims to customary land, community authority and forest access.

Social reform vs anti-caste transformation: Changing specific practices does not always challenge the underlying caste hierarchy.

Gandhi vs Ambedkar: Both opposed untouchability, but differed sharply on caste, representation and political safeguards.

Telangana caution: Nizam-ruled Hyderabad State had distinct institutions; the Telangana armed peasant struggle is twentieth-century history.

Detailed Notes

Editorial status: Expanded draft; independent page-level historical audit pending.

Resistance as a historical category

Beyond a single nationalist chronology

Resistance to colonial rule included armed insurgency, tax refusal, litigation, petitions, religious organization, strikes, print campaigns and efforts to reclaim forests or customary rights. These forms did not always share the objective of an independent nation-state. A tribal rebellion defending access to forests and a middle-class constitutional association could oppose aspects of colonial power while imagining different political futures. Good history recovers the stated demands and social location of participants rather than retroactively treating every protest as a fully formed nationalist movement.

Colonial transformation and its uneven impact

Changes in revenue collection, policing, courts, property relations, forest regulation and commercial agriculture disrupted older political bargains. Moneylenders, contractors, landlords, missionaries and local chiefs interacted with colonial institutions in different ways. Some communities experienced dispossession and coercion; others gained access to new occupations or education. The causes of unrest were therefore layered: economic pressure could combine with perceived religious interference, erosion of customary authority, or immediate grievances against officials and intermediaries.

Sources and their silences

Official reports frequently classified rebels as criminals or fanatics; nationalist narratives sometimes simplified diverse motives into patriotic unity. Oral traditions, petitions, local-language writings, judicial proceedings and land records help reconstruct alternative perspectives. A responsible answer separates documented grievances, participant claims, colonial allegations and later interpretation. It also avoids assuming that a rebellion had uniform leadership or that all members of a community participated.

Tribal and peasant uprisings in the nineteenth century

Santhal Hul, 1855–56

The Santhal rebellion in the Damin-i-Koh region challenged exploitation associated with moneylenders, traders, revenue authorities and police. Sidhu and Kanhu are prominent leaders in its remembered history. The uprising combined defense of community life with a wider rejection of oppressive institutions; colonial suppression was violent. It is useful to connect the Hul to the long-term question of how land, debt and administrative jurisdiction reshaped Adivasi society, without claiming all Santhal grievances were identical.

Kol uprising and the frontier of property

The Kol uprising of 1831–32 in the Chotanagpur region reflected pressures generated by the entry of outsiders, revenue changes and challenges to customary control over land. The term Kol was an administrative umbrella rather than a precise description of every participating group. Exam answers should identify the regional context and structural issues instead of reducing the movement to a spontaneous reaction against outsiders.

Munda Ulgulan, 1899–1900

Birsa Munda emerged as a religious and political leader in Chotanagpur. His movement opposed the erosion of customary landholding, exploitative intermediaries and colonial authority. The Ulgulan, or great tumult, drew on ideas of social renewal as well as political resistance. Birsa died in custody in 1900. Later tenancy protections were shaped by broader and longer struggles, and the Chotanagpur Tenancy Act of 1908 should not be described as a direct immediate concession issued during the uprising.

Indigo revolt and the politics of contracts

In Bengal in 1859–60, cultivators resisted coercive indigo cultivation and unfavorable advances. The movement drew on village solidarity, petitions, public debate and the support of sections of the press and intelligentsia. It shows that peasants could coordinate non-military forms of collective action and that commercial crops did not automatically imply voluntary market exchange. The Indigo Commission of 1860 investigated grievances; its existence does not imply that exploitation vanished.

Deccan disturbances, 1875

In western India, the Deccan riots arose amid agrarian indebtedness, disputes over credit, revenue obligations and the aftermath of changing cotton-market conditions. Protesters targeted moneylenders and debt documents in some localities. The Deccan Agriculturists Relief Act of 1879 was a subsequent attempt to address aspects of rural indebtedness. Avoid representing it as comprehensive land reform or treating all creditor–debtor relations as ethnically uniform.

Telangana and Hyderabad State distinction

Nineteenth-century Hyderabad State was governed by the Nizam and had its own revenue, jagir and administrative arrangements under British paramountcy; it was not simply another British province under Permanent or Ryotwari settlement. Resistance in the Telangana region must be situated in this distinct political geography. The later Telangana peasant armed struggle belongs primarily to the twentieth century and should not be incorrectly dated as a nineteenth-century revolt.

The revolt of 1857: causes, spread and limits

Long-term political and economic causes

Annexations, including Awadh in 1856, unsettled rulers, taluqdars and soldiers linked to older states. Revenue pressures, changes in military employment and resentment toward the Company contributed to unrest. The Doctrine of Lapse affected selected princely houses but does not explain every annexation; Awadh was taken on the stated ground of misgovernment. Discontent among peasants, artisans and elites varied by region and cannot be compressed into a single cause.

Sepoy grievances and immediate trigger

The introduction of the Enfield rifle and controversy over cartridges believed to be greased with cow and pig fat sharpened religious anxieties among sepoys. The issue mattered because it intersected with accumulated grievances about pay, allowances, service conditions and fears of interference with religious practices. The uprising at Meerut on 10 May 1857 and the march to Delhi gave the rebellion a major symbolic center under Bahadur Shah Zafar. The cartridge controversy was a trigger, not an adequate complete explanation.

Regional centers and leadership

Important centers included Delhi, Kanpur, Lucknow, Jhansi, Gwalior and parts of Bihar. Rani Lakshmibai, Begum Hazrat Mahal, Nana Sahib, Tantia Tope and Kunwar Singh became prominent figures in different regional contexts. Alliances and goals differed; some sought restoration of older authority, others opposed specific local grievances. Many princely rulers and social groups did not join, and the south and large parts of Punjab did not experience the same pattern of revolt.

Why the revolt failed militarily

The rebels lacked unified command, a common program and reliable coordination across theaters. The Company and British forces drew on better-connected logistical networks, reinforcements, loyal princely allies and Indian soldiers who did not rebel. The balance of resources changed over time. Describing the outcome as a simple defeat of courage by technology ignores political alliances, communications and regional variation.

Consequences: Crown rule and military reorganization

The Government of India Act 1858 ended Company government and transferred authority to the British Crown. The Queen’s Proclamation of 1858 promised non-interference in religious matters and respect for treaties with princely rulers, though practice was uneven. Army recruitment, command and the proportion of European to Indian troops were reorganized; imperial authorities increasingly emphasized political surveillance and categories of loyalty. The revolt shaped both colonial policy and later nationalist memory.

Interpretive debate

British contemporary accounts often called 1857 a sepoy mutiny, highlighting its military origins. Nationalist writers later emphasized a war of independence. Modern historians examine multiple regional rebellions and the participation of peasants, landlords, soldiers and urban groups. A balanced mains answer explains what each label illuminates and obscures; it should not present one contested phrase as a universally agreed scholarly conclusion.

The rise of Indian nationalism

Material and intellectual foundations

English-language education, vernacular newspapers, new associations, railways, postal networks and legal institutions enabled wider communication among educated Indians. These infrastructures were not created for nationalism alone, but Indians repurposed them. Modern political ideas about representation and rights interacted with Indian histories of resistance, reform and public debate. The spread of nationalist consciousness was gradual and uneven across class, caste, gender and region.

Economic critique as political argument

Dadabhai Naoroji's drain theory and R. C. Dutt's critique of colonial economic policy translated material grievances into arguments about accountability and self-government. Famines, discriminatory employment practices and racial inequalities sharpened demands. The Ilbert Bill controversy of 1883 exposed racial limits to claims of liberal equality. Economic nationalism thus connected revenue, industry and public expenditure to the question of who possessed political power.

Associations and the Congress

Regional public associations and political campaigns preceded the Indian National Congress, founded in 1885. Early Congress leaders used petitions, resolutions and constitutional arguments to press for reform and Indian participation in administration. Their social base was limited, but their organizations developed common political vocabulary and networks. Later mass politics transformed rather than simply replaced this organizational inheritance.

Internal tensions in nationalism

Anti-colonial unity coexisted with disputes over caste hierarchy, women's rights, religion, class interests and the representation of marginalized communities. An exam answer should distinguish nationalism as a struggle against imperial rule from the separate question of whether nationalist organizations were socially inclusive. Anti-caste leaders sometimes challenged both colonial institutions and upper-caste domination within Indian society.

Socio-religious reform and anti-caste assertion

Brahmo Samaj and reformist public reason

Raja Rammohun Roy founded the Brahmo Sabha in 1828, associated with the later Brahmo Samaj tradition. Its reformist currents criticized practices such as sati and advocated religious monotheism, education and social change. Reform involved engagement with scripture, reason and the colonial public sphere; it was not uniformly radical on every question of caste or gender. Different leaders and branches took different positions over time.

Arya Samaj and competing reform projects

Dayanand Saraswati founded the Arya Samaj in 1875, calling for a return to the authority of the Vedas while promoting education and challenging certain inherited practices. Its interpretations of caste, religious identity and reconversion developed amid wider contestation. Brahmo and Arya reform cannot be treated as interchangeable: they differed in scriptural orientation, religious philosophy and social constituencies.

Aligarh Movement and Muslim educational change

Sir Syed Ahmad Khan promoted modern scientific and English education among Indian Muslims; the Muhammadan Anglo-Oriental College at Aligarh was founded in 1875 and later developed into Aligarh Muslim University in 1920. The movement combined educational modernization with debates about social and political strategy after 1857. It should not be reduced to a single position held by all Muslims or treated as identical with later communal politics.

Jyotirao and Savitribai Phule

Jyotirao Phule and Savitribai Phule challenged caste exclusion and promoted education for girls and marginalized communities in western India. Their work included schools in Pune beginning in 1848. Jyotirao founded the Satyashodhak Samaj in 1873, rejecting Brahmanical dominance and asserting dignity and equality. Savitribai was an educator, organizer

and writer in her own right; reducing her to a supporting role erases an important intellectual and political contribution.

Pandita Ramabai and women's autonomy

Pandita Ramabai criticized patriarchal restrictions and advocated women's education and autonomy, particularly for widows. Her activism crossed linguistic, religious and institutional boundaries and sometimes generated controversy. The significance of her work lies not merely in welfare provision but in the argument that women were entitled to knowledge, mobility and agency.

Narayana Guru and Ayyankali

In Kerala, Narayana Guru challenged caste restrictions through spiritual and social reform and the affirmation of human dignity. Ayyankali organized struggles concerning access to public roads, education and the rights of oppressed-caste agricultural workers. Their approaches differed, but both reveal why social equality cannot be inferred automatically from formal political reform.

Annie Besant and the overlapping spheres of reform

Annie Besant's activities spanned the Theosophical Society, education and the Home Rule movement. She helped popularize demands for self-government, especially in 1916–17, while also advancing educational institutions. Her career illustrates overlap between religious-cultural revival, civic organization and nationalism, although these were not a single unified program.

Non-Brahmin, Justice and Self-Respect movements

Non-Brahmin politics in southern India

The South Indian Liberal Federation, commonly associated with the Justice Party and established in 1916, articulated non-Brahmin demands in the Madras Presidency. Representation in education, government employment and public institutions was central. The movement should be located in the politics of caste access and colonial constitutional reform; its social reach and elite leadership also deserve scrutiny.

Periyar and Self-Respect

E. V. Ramasamy, known as Periyar, advanced the Self-Respect Movement from 1925, attacking caste hierarchy, patriarchy, ritual inequality and inherited authority. Self-respect marriages and rationalist critique sought to change everyday social relations, not simply secure seats in government. His relations with Congress politics and other non-Brahmin currents evolved over time; Justice Party and Self-Respect Movement are related but not identical institutions.

Gandhi, Ambedkar and the representation debate

Mahatma Gandhi opposed untouchability and mobilized large-scale campaigns for social reform, while B. R. Ambedkar emphasized caste annihilation, legal safeguards, education, political representation and the rights of oppressed communities. Their disagreement over separate electorates culminated in the Poona Pact of 1932, which provided reserved seats within joint electorates. A rigorous answer recognizes shared opposition to untouchability while explaining profound differences over caste structure, political autonomy and the means of emancipation.

Synthesis for examination

Reform movements can be compared across five axes: diagnosis of inequality; social base; method (education, spiritual reinterpretation, direct action, political representation); relationship with colonial rule; and position on caste and gender. Avoid a triumphalist narrative in which every reform automatically produced equality. Many movements faced internal exclusions, competing visions and slow institutional change.

Visual Learning

Revolt-causation chain

Colonial revenue/property changes + customary rights erosion + debt/coercion + political exclusion → localized grievances → collective organization → protest or uprising → repression, negotiation and uneven legal change.

1857 multi-causal diagram

- Political: Annexations; displacement of rulers and taluqdars

- Military: Service conditions; allowances; cartridge controversy

- Socio-religious: Fears of interference and loss of customary practices

- Economic: Agrarian and elite grievances, differing by region

- Outcome: Crown rule (1858); army and administrative restructuring

Comparison matrix

| Movement | Principal setting | Core issue | Key caution |

|---|---|---|---|

| Santhal Hul | Damin-i-Koh | Debt, outsiders, official oppression | Not identical to 1857 |

| Indigo revolt | Bengal | Coercive crop contracts | Not primarily a sepoy revolt |

| Deccan disturbances | Western India | Debt and credit | Not a general anti-moneylender ethnicity claim |

| Ulgulan | Chotanagpur | Land rights and social renewal | Do not overstate direct legislative causation |

| Justice Party | Madras Presidency | Non-Brahmin representation | Different from Self-Respect movement |

| Self-Respect | Tamil region | Caste and gender hierarchy | Broader than electoral reform |

All diagrams are original study aids, not statistical evidence.

Original Practice

MCQ 1. Which movement is most closely associated with resistance to coercive cultivation contracts in Bengal during 1859–60?

A. Santhal Hul B. Indigo revolt C. Ulgulan D. Deccan disturbances

Correct: B. Indigo cultivators protested planter coercion. A concerned Santhal grievances in 1855–56; C is associated with Birsa Munda in 1899–1900; D occurred in western India in 1875.

MCQ 2. Which development followed the suppression of the revolt of 1857?

A. Company diwani in Bengal B. Transfer of rule to the Crown C. Founding of Congress D. Permanent Settlement

Correct: B. The Government of India Act 1858 ended Company government. A was 1765; C was 1885; D was 1793.

MCQ 3. Which pairing is correct?

A. Satyashodhak Samaj—Periyar B. Self-Respect Movement—Jyotirao Phule C. Arya Samaj—Dayanand Saraswati D. Brahmo Sabha—Sir Syed Ahmad Khan

Correct: C. Dayanand founded Arya Samaj in 1875. Jyotirao founded Satyashodhak Samaj; Periyar advanced Self-Respect; Rammohun Roy founded Brahmo Sabha.

MCQ 4. The Poona Pact of 1932 is most closely associated with disagreement about:

A. Railway finance B. Political representation of Depressed Classes C. Indigo pricing D. Subsidiary alliances

Correct: B. Gandhi and Ambedkar disagreed over separate electorates and representation. Other options are unrelated.

Mains prompts (original)

1. Examine the causes, social composition and consequences of the revolt of 1857. (20 marks)

2. Compare tribal and peasant uprisings of the nineteenth century as responses to colonial transformation. (15 marks)

3. Discuss how anti-caste movements reshaped the meaning of social reform and nationalism. (20 marks)

Answer Blueprints

Q1: 1857 (20 marks)

Opening: Describe a multi-centered rebellion with sepoy origins and diverse civil participation. Body: political annexation; military grievances and cartridge trigger; agrarian/elite participation; regional centers and limits; causes of defeat; Crown takeover and army reorganization. Nuance: competing labels of mutiny and first war of independence. Conclusion: watershed, not geographically universal revolution.

Q2: Tribal and peasant uprisings (15 marks)

Opening: Link colonial property, revenue and markets to protest. Body: Santhal Hul, Kol, Ulgulan; Indigo and Deccan cases; compare customary land rights, coercive contracts and debt; discuss methods and repression. Nuance: overlapping categories and regional specificity. Conclusion: resistance exposes unequal market and state power.

Q3: Anti-caste movements (20 marks)

Opening: Political freedom and social equality were connected but not identical goals. Body: Phules, Narayana Guru, Ayyankali, Pandita Ramabai; Justice Party and Periyar; Gandhi–Ambedkar debate; education, representation, gender and caste annihilation. Nuance: movements differed in social bases and political strategies. Conclusion: widened citizenship claims and contested nationalist priorities.

Complete Model Answers

Q1. Examine the causes, social composition and consequences of the revolt of 1857. (20 marks)

The revolt of 1857 began with military unrest but developed into a series of interconnected regional rebellions. Its origins lay in the interaction of political annexation, military grievances, agrarian pressures and fears about religious interference.

The Company’s expansion unsettled princes, taluqdars and their dependents. The annexation of Awadh in 1856, officially justified on grounds of misgovernment, alienated influential groups. Sepoys resented service conditions and perceived threats to religious practice; the Enfield cartridge controversy became an immediate trigger. The outbreak at Meerut on 10 May 1857 and the move to Delhi invested the Mughal emperor Bahadur Shah Zafar with symbolic authority. Elsewhere, Rani Lakshmibai in Jhansi, Begum Hazrat Mahal in Awadh, Nana Sahib at Kanpur and Kunwar Singh in Bihar represented different regional coalitions. Soldiers, landholders, townspeople and peasants participated in varying proportions.

The rebellion was not geographically uniform. Many rulers, communities and soldiers remained outside it or supported British forces. Rebels struggled with fragmented command, uneven supplies and incompatible objectives; Company forces used reinforcements, communications and political alliances to suppress major centers.

The Government of India Act 1858 transferred power from the Company to the Crown. The Queen’s Proclamation promised respect for treaties and non-interference in religion, while the army and administrative apparatus were reorganized. Colonial governance became more cautious about princely relations yet more attentive to surveillance and military control.

The term “sepoy mutiny” captures the military ignition but underplays civilian participation; “first war of independence” highlights anti-colonial significance but risks suggesting a single national program. The revolt was a watershed because it transformed imperial rule and later nationalist memory, despite its diverse aims and regional limits.

Q2. Compare tribal and peasant uprisings of the nineteenth century as responses to colonial transformation. (15 marks)

Nineteenth-century tribal and peasant uprisings emerged from changes in land rights, revenue collection, credit relations and commercial production. Their immediate demands varied, but each revealed conflict over who controlled resources and institutions under colonial expansion.

The Kol uprising in Chotanagpur in 1831–32 reflected challenges to customary authority and landholding. The Santhal Hul of 1855–56 resisted the oppressive nexus of moneylenders, traders and colonial officials in the Damin-i-Koh region. Birsa Munda's Ulgulan of 1899–1900 combined land-rights grievances with religious and social renewal. Such movements often invoked community control, dignity and established patterns of resource access.

Peasant protest in commercial agriculture displayed related but distinct dynamics. Bengal's indigo revolt of 1859–60 challenged coercive contracts and unfavorable planter terms, using collective refusal and public advocacy. The Deccan disturbances of 1875 targeted debt and creditor power amid revenue and market pressures. Their participants did not necessarily demand an end to all commerce; they opposed unequal conditions of participation.

These categories overlap: Adivasi cultivators could be peasants, and peasant politics could include caste and customary-rights claims. Colonial responses ranged from repression to inquiries and partial legislative adjustments. The movements did not all articulate modern nationalism, yet they revealed the social costs of unequal state and market power and expanded the repertoire of collective resistance.

Q3. Discuss how anti-caste movements reshaped the meaning of social reform and nationalism. (20 marks)

Anti-caste movements argued that political liberty would remain incomplete without social equality. They challenged a reform agenda limited to changing selected customs while leaving inherited hierarchies intact.

Jyotirao and Savitribai Phule made education a means of confronting caste and gender exclusion. Their schools and the Satyashodhak Samaj attacked claims of hereditary superiority and asserted the dignity of marginalized communities. In Kerala, Narayana Guru challenged ritual inequality, while Ayyankali organized for access to roads, schools and agricultural workers' rights. Pandita Ramabai's advocacy for women's education and autonomy demonstrated that gendered power required direct challenge rather than paternalistic protection.

In southern India, the Justice Party pressed for non-Brahmin representation in public employment and institutions. Periyar's Self-Respect Movement pushed further into everyday social relations, questioning caste ritual, patriarchy and marriage practices. These approaches illustrate the difference between access to existing institutions and transformation of social norms.

Gandhi campaigned against untouchability and sought moral reform within a broad nationalist movement. Ambedkar insisted that caste hierarchy demanded structural change, enforceable rights and independent political voice. Their dispute over separate electorates, culminating in the Poona Pact of 1932, exposed a fundamental tension between nationalist unity and representation of historically excluded groups.

Anti-caste politics thus widened the meaning of freedom: it required education, dignity, gender equality, public access and political safeguards, not simply transfer of state power. The movements differed in philosophy and strategy, but together they made social democracy an indispensable question for Indian nationalism.

Verified MCQs

None authenticated in this pass. All MCQs supplied are original practice, not official PYQs.

Verified Mains PYQs

None authenticated in this pass. All mains prompts and answers are original teaching material.

Current Affairs

Verification pending as of 22 October 2026. No unverified current event is presented as fact. Research leads for the final edition include recent archives digitization, conservation of 1857 memorials, tribal-rights policy and anti-discrimination legislation. These are thematic connections, not verified 2026 news.

References

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- Sumit Sarkar, *Modern India, 1885–1947* — nationalism and social politics.

- Rosalind O'Hanlon, *Caste, Conflict and Ideology: Mahatma Jotirao Phule and Low Caste Protest in Nineteenth-Century Western India* — Phule and caste critique.

- Gail Omvedt, *Cultural Revolt in a Colonial Society* — non-Brahmin politics.

- NCERT, *Our Pasts III*, chapters on tribal communities, 1857 and reform (edition dependent).

- TGPSC Notification 02/2024 Annexure-II — inherited official syllabus transcription.

Audit note: These are bibliographic leads. Specific statements have not yet been independently page-verified; official PYQs and 2026 current affairs remain unverified.

Quality Audit

- [x] Official-syllabus topics mapped

- [x] Explanatory historical chapters with interpretive qualifications

- [x] Four explained original MCQs

- [x] Three original mains questions with blueprints and full model answers

- [x] Self-contained PDF generated

- [ ] Independent page-level source audit

- [ ] Authenticated official PYQs

- [ ] Source-verified current affairs

- [ ] External academic review

Status: expanded draft, NOT approved.

Anti-British Uprisings, Nationalism and Social Reform — critical mains facts

TGPSC Group I Mains | Paper II | Detailed educational draft | NOT academically approved

High-value evidence and analytical connections

High-value examples omitted by generic revision

Santhal Hul (1855–56): leadership associated with Sidhu and Kanhu, land alienation and moneylender–zamindar exploitation in the Damin-i-Koh context; distinguish it from Birsa Munda's Ulgulan (1899–1900) against alienation and colonial governance. Indigo Revolt (1859–60): planter contracts and coercion, with Bengali public mobilisation; Deccan Riots (1875): credit and cotton-market distress. 1857: distinguish sepoy grievances (greased-cartridge controversy and service concerns) from annexation, taluqdari and landed discontent; name Meerut, Delhi, Kanpur, Lucknow and Jhansi, leaders Bahadur Shah Zafar, Nana Sahib, Begum Hazrat Mahal and Rani Lakshmibai, and regional differences. Aftermath: 1858 Crown takeover, end of Company's rule, army reorganisation and changed princely-state policy. Social reform: Raja Ram Mohan Roy and the 1829 sati abolition regulation, Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar and Widow Remarriage Act 1856, Jyotirao and Savitribai Phule's education and anti-caste work, Narayana Guru and Ambedkar's later critique. Always link a named action/institution to the problem being addressed; labels like 'reform for women' earn little explanatory weight.

Verification gate: a primary-source or scholarly page-level audit is still required before these educational summaries can be marked approved.